A Star Fleet Battles[tm] Rule Proposal
Copyright © 2025-2026 by David Bank
This rule has not been reviewed, tested, endorsed, approved or published by ADB, Inc.

(M___.0) ANDROMEDAN SPATIAL DISTORTION CHARGE

Appearing during the Fourth Stage of Andromedan Invasion of the Milky Way (R10.1E1), and bearing some similarities to the Andromedan Gravity Mine (M___.0), the Spatial Distortion Charge is thought to be a belated attempt by Andromedan forces to deal with the cloaking technologies of some Milky Way empires. This system, first seen in early Y186, was rarely observed in general, and almost never outside of Romulan space. It was suggested that the Andromedans were unable to widely deploy it.

No other empire understands the operating principles of the Spatial Distortion Charge. In the event this device is obtained by another empire, it cannot be copied, armed or deployed.

(M___.1) DESCRIPTION

(M___.11) DEFINITION: A Spatial Distortion Charge (SDC) is a small, mine-like system carried by some Andromedan ships. While bearing some similarities to mines, SDCs are not mines, and function differently in a number of ways. Similar to (M3.14), SDCs carried on board a ship are not represented on the ship portion of the SSD, and cannot be deactivated or detonated by enemy boarding parties.

(M___.12) AVAILABILITY: In a campaign setting, or for the purposes of modifying existing scenarios, Y182 is the earliest an Andromedan ship could carry SDCs (the assertion that this system was not seen until Y186 is based on the first *confirmed* record from a surviving Alpha Octant ship; it was suspected that the system actually appeared earlier).

(M___.121) Purchasing Spatial Distortion Charges does not count against the Maximum Load (M3.13) of transporter bombs for the ship.

(M___.122) There is no "dummy" (M2.9) version of an SDC.

(M___.123) Only Size Class 4, or larger, ships may carry SDCs.

(M___.124) An Andromedan ship may purchase a maximum number of SDCs, according to its Size Class, as follows: Size Class 4, 3; Size Class 3, 4; Size Class 2, 6.

(M___.125) The Andromedan Krait (R10.23) may not use SDCs in a tournament.

(M___.13) COST: A Spatial Distortion Charge costs one BPV and may only be purchased as a Commander's Option (Andromedan ships did not ordinarily carry any).

(M___.14) CONDITIONS: Spatial Distortion Charges are subject to (M2.2).

(M___.15) CARGO: An individual Spatial Distortion Charge is one-quarter the size of a small mine; if carried in cargo it occupies 0.5 spaces. An Andromedan base may purchase SDCs as cargo, but cannot purchase additional SDCs in excess of that shown in (M___.124).

(M___.2) DEPLOYMENT

(M___.21) TRANSPORTER REQUIRED: The only method for deploying a Spatial Distortion Charge is transporter (M3.22). This occurs at the same point in the Sequence of Play (6B7) as mines are deployed by transporters.

(M___.211) Deploying an SDC does not limit the deployment of mines, during the same impulse, *via* transporter or any other means.

(M___.212) It is possible to deploy multiple SDCs during the same impulse. The only limiting factor is the number of available transporters.

(M___.22) ARMING: A Spatial Distortion Charge "arms" immediately upon deployment (the moment it materializes). There is no requirement that the deploying ship move away from the SDC.

(M___.23) DESTRUCTION: A deployed Spatial Distortion Charge can be destroyed by one point of damage. It may be destroyed by an ESG, as if it were a mine (G23.61), but it will "detonate"; an armed SDC is treated as "explosive" for the purposes of (G23.612). Technically, an SDC might also be swept as a mine (M8.0), but it's unlikely that there would be an opportunity to do so.

(M___.3) OPERATION

(M___.31) DETONATION: Two impulses after it is deployed, the Spatial Distortion Charge "detonates". This occurs at the start of the SEPARATIONS STAGE (6B10). The SDC is not triggered (*e.g.* by movement), so the event happens regardless of any movement near it.

(M___.32) EFFECT: When it "detonates", the Spatial Distortion Charge creates a very weak Spherical Gravity Wave (P9.4), centered in the hex where the SDC was deployed. The SDC itself is destroyed.

(M___.321) The wave advances as *per* (P9.41), but produces no damage, has no effect on seeking weapons, and cannot change the facing of a unit.

(M___.322) This wave advances once and then dissipates with no further effect.

(M___.323) If this wave intersects with any other Gravity Wave, the intersecting portion of the SDC-generated wave is "cancelled out" and ceases to have any further effect. Note that at least one wave will have effect in a hex where multiple waves intersect.

(M___.4) EFFECT ON CLOAKED UNITS

(M___.41) NEW DIE ROLL: When the wave generated by an SDC enters a hex occupied by a cloaked unit, other units seeking to regain lock-on to the cloaked unit may make a new die roll (G13.332). The wave does not itself assist or impede the new die roll. This is similar to (G13.48), but takes place despite the lack of damage.

(M___.42) SAME HEX: If a cloaked unit is in the same hex when the SDC "detonates", this is treated as if the wave had "entered" the hex.

(M___.42) SINGLE WAVE EFFECTIVE: If multiple SDCs are deployed in such a way that more than one SDC-generated Gravity Wave enters a hex occupied by a cloaked unit during an impulse, then only one new die roll is enabled. Do not make a separate die roll *per* wave.

Copyright © 2025-2026 by David Bank

(M___.5) OTHER EFFECTS

(M___.51) NO OTHER EFFECTS: Except as below, SDCs cause no other combat effects; no EW points are generated, no damage is caused, and no is power absorbed.

(M___.52) PLANETARY EFFECTS: If an SDC were deployed to a planetary surface, the "detonation" causes one point of damage to the planet and any units on that facing of the planet, but is not strong enough to cause in-flight units to crash (P9.332) or cause damage elsewhere on the planet. An SDC deployed to a hex adjacent to a planet has no effect on the surface of the planet; or, on uncloaked in-flight units or orbital units.

Without limiting the exclusive rights of any author, contributor and/or authorized publisher of this creative work, the use of this publication to train artificial intelligence, of a "generative" type, or of any other type known or unknown at the time of publication, is expressly prohibited. The copyright holder also exercises their rights under Article 4(3) of the Digital Single Market Directive 2019/790 and expressly reserves this publication from the text and data mining exceptions.